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Mistrial but no end in Clancy case



ABOVE: SJC; GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

Lindsay Clancy and her lawyer, Kevin Reddington, during the emergency SJC hearing. Reddington (right) sought a delay in the declaration of a mistrial. Judge William Sullivan (left) gave him an hour to appeal to the state's highest court.



Defense loses last-minute bid to remove juror

By Shelley Murphy and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht and Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

PLYMOUTH — After 38 hours of deliberation over seven days, a mistrial was declared Friday in Lindsay Clancy's murder trial after jurors alerted the judge they were hopelessly deadlocked over whether she is criminally responsible for killing her three children in 2023.

►What happens next is largely up to the district attorney. B1.

"It is with a heavy heart we report we are unable to come to a unanimous decision," jurors wrote. It was the fourth time since Tuesday they signaled they were at an impasse.

Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan granted the mistrial after a last-minute appeal to a single justice of the state's highest court by Clancy's attorney, who challenged the judge's refusal to remove the single juror who appeared to be a holdout.

Once that appeal was denied, Sullivan called jurors into the courtroom and told them they were being released.

Two jurors, including one who buried her face in her hands, cried as the judge declared the case officially over and thanked them for working so hard.

The ruling capped an extraordinary period of tension and drama over whether one juror, whom Clancy's attorney claimed was the lone holdout against acquittal, was refusing to follow the judge's

VERDICT, Page A6

Crime and coverage combined for media spectacle

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Just before 8:30 Friday morning, under a thick fog, a line of photographers and reporters waited in a row behind Plymouth Superior Court for the daily start of the Lindsay Clancy murder trial. When attorney Kevin Reddington approached from his car, they bolted forward, surrounding him with a mass of mics, cameras, and cell-phones.

Photographers, some walking backward to keep up, repeatedly yelled at Reddington to step to the podium. One had a visible cut above his nose after he was hit; another person fell to the ground.

"This is not normal," one

quipped.

Once again, a suburban Massachusetts courthouse was the center of a media maelstrom this week, as people across the world followed the trial of Lindsay Clancy, the Duxbury mom charged with killing her three children. Amid extended jury deliberations, and despite little new news, the media circus grew by the day until Friday's declaration of a mistrial — a spectacle highlighting how the combination of social media, enthusiasm for true crime, and wall-to-wall news coverage can set off a firestorm.

It is, of course, the third trial-turned-media-event south of Boston in the last few years, on the heels of the two Karen Read trials, in 2024

and 2025. And while the attention is national, it is felt most intensely here in our backyard, said Kathryn Coduto, assistant professor of media science at Boston University who researches true crime.

"I think the Boston media environment helps some of these cases to take off in a national spotlight," she said. "That combination of this rich media industry alongside the growth of interest in crime stories, it kind of makes it a perfect recipe for a story like this."

There has always been a gap between the trial as it happens in the courtroom and the trial as it is communicated to the public. Ever since the start of nationally televised tri-

MEDIA, Page A7

Legal experts unsurprised by SJC decision not to intervene

By Mike Damiano, Laura Crimaldi, and John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Over just a few short hours Friday, the fate of accused murderer Lindsay Clancy rested on an extraordinary legal battle that went all the way to the state's highest court, as her lawyer sought to have a holdout juror removed from the trial.

But ultimately, legal analysts said, attorney Kevin Reddington's argument that a rogue juror was refusing to follow legal instructions was always going to be a long shot and that a mistrial seemed inevitable.

Courts are extremely hesitant to intervene in jury deliberations and generally only do so when a juror's honesty or impartiality can be called into doubt, lawyers said in interviews with the Globe.

And, in the Clancy case, they said, that high bar was not met.

On Friday afternoon, Judge William F. Sullivan made official what had seemed clear for days: The jury was hopelessly deadlocked. He declared a mistrial.

Sullivan's decision followed two days of legal wrangling that included Clancy's defense attorney, Kevin Reddington, accusing a holdout ju-

ANALYSIS, Page A6

Blue Hill Ave. plan adds parking spots

But center-running bus lane still a key feature

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

For years, residents and politicians have railed against the plan to reconfigure Blue Hill Avenue and the impact that proposed bus and bike lanes could unleash on the busy corridor through the heart of Black Boston.

Now city officials and the MBTA say they've funneled those concerns into a new design that preserves a controversial center-running bus lane but significantly expands the portions of the boulevard with two traffic lanes on each side.

The new plan shrinks the amount of proposed bike lanes to dedicate more of the road to motor vehicle travel and parking between Grove Hall and Mattapan Square, effectively creating a more car-friendly design.

Mayor Michelle Wu billed the plan as a "generationally transformational" layout, with \$163 million in improvements to public transit and other public works that she said the

BLUE HILL AVENUE, Page A10

Turnpike rest stops, there when you need them

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

THE MASS. PIKE — Fiona Wong looks around to make sure no one can hear her, then drops her voice to a whisper before she commits the cardinal sin of stating the obvious.

REPORTER'S NOTEBOOK

"This place is low-key dingy," she says as she glances at the ... well, there's not much to look at. "But I low-key like it."

Wong is a teenager who works at the Dunkin' inside the Westborough Service Plaza on the Mass. Pike.

If your bladder lives in the Bay State, you probably know this rest stop, or its more-or-less identical twins on the pike in Framingham, Natick, and Charlton (East and West).

Their familiarity and identity are, for many travelers, so ingrained in the brain that you navigate them instinctually. Your mind knows where the McDonald's is located. It knows where the claw machines are. It knows that there's not much to know.

But know this: They're all set to disappear, these five utilitarian icons that are the first and last rest stops you hit on I-90, that great ribbon of asphalt that connects Boston to Seattle, the Atlantic to the Pacific.

The state has made a mess of the bidding process to modernize the facilities, but when they finally get their act together, these familiar five will either be bulldozed or renovated beyond recognition.

Before that day comes, let's pay re-

REST STOPS, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Tables and diners at the Framingham Service Plaza on the westbound side of the Massachusetts Turnpike.

President Trump threatened to halt a broad swath of US trade unless the Federal Reserve slashed interest rates. A2.

Two mud-caked survivors were rescued from min-

ing tunnels in Nepal, a week and a half after deadly flooding. A3.

Locations of the state's automated license plate reader cameras must be shared with the public along with information

about when State Police search the system's database, a judge ruled. B1.

More than 1,000 workers at Encore Boston Harbor went on strike, just before the Labor Day weekend began. D1.

Grays and rays

Saturday: Sun and clouds. High: 69-74. Low: 58-63.

Sunday: Sunny. High: 68-73. Low: 58-63. Comics and Weather, D4-5. Obituaries, C9.

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